

CAREER PATHS

Depending on where you study, you may need to choose a specialty during your degree, although you can usually change direction later. Experienced nurses are valued in hospital management and public health roles.

ASSISTANT Working as an assistant can provide useful experience before you apply for a nursing degree program.

GRADUATE You must have a nursing degree to register as a nurse. The course can take four years to complete and includes supervised clinical time.



LICENSED PRACTICAL NURSE
Takes samples, removes or replaces dressings, and performs other health checks. Doctors rely heavily on the help of practice nurses to support them.



SKILLS GUIDE



Good communication skills to help when working with people from different backgrounds.



The ability to work successfully as part of a team in this busy, demanding profession.



Natural compassion and empathy when providing support to patients and their families.



A sense of humor to help motivate patients suffering from challenging conditions.



Physical strength and good stamina when moving patients and equipment.

PEDIATRIC NURSE

Works with children of all ages to provide health care in children's homes and hospitals.



REGISTERED NURSE
Most nurses begin work with the general adult population, where there are the largest number of job vacancies. They can then specialize.

HOSPICE NURSE
Provides supportive care to people who are terminally ill and works with their families to plan end-of-life responsibilities.

PSYCHIATRIC NURSE
Helps patients in their recovery from mental health conditions. They administer appropriate medication and work with patients to help them lead fuller, more independent lives.

NURSE PRACTITIONER
Very experienced nurse, with advanced education and clinical training. Many focus in a certain area, like neonatal or psychiatric health.

